

International SIMx

National Geography launches its own dual-sim phone: the Duet D888. It has one slot for your international sim card and another slot to hold the SIM card of a local carrier of your choice

Nokia for the talkative

Nokia has just unveiled a new member of its E-Series phone - the Nokia E52. And topping the list of this phone's features is an 8 hours talk time

the facia but these have to be pressed and they're not touch activated. The call buttons are well located but are a bit hard. The joypad has a slightly sharp rim that may annoy your finger pads while using but it's not overly uncomfortable. The middle button is sweet - offers good feedback. The volume button on the side is a joy to use. The camera button is soft and halfway down the click, it engages the autofocus. The screen is brilliant and crisp - 16 million colours, 2.4-inches and a resolution of 240 x 320 pixels



Nokia N78

keeps things amazingly legible.

The camera is capable of taking some sweet shots although you need to tinker with the settings to get things right. The music playback quality is really good and the handsfree unit will give clear sound at high volume levels. Signal reception is really good with good clarity and detail, no chinks in the armour here and the earpiece is very clear and very loud. Even while playing music the loudspeaker is clear and if you don't mind the anaemic bass you'll get along fine. It's packed to the gills with features and comes with a 2 GB card as well, but it doesn't come cheap at Rs. 17,479. The Symbian interface has been optimised for multimedia and this makes a good phone for PMP lovers or someone looking at a good camera. It's the best overall handset within this category.

Empowered multimedia Multimedia phones from Rs. 20,001 - Rs. 27,500

Nokia N79

Released shortly after the N78, the N79 adds a better keypad, high megapixel rated camera and little else. It has a similar footprint, and the genes of the N73 are strongly evident. The phone itself is finished in a glossy fibre that doesn't look as good as the N78's finish to us. Build quality is good and the issue with the N78's battery cover is not present here as

Nokia worked on the retention mechanism. The menu and call buttons are little more than slits and while they are clearly raised and backlit we feel usability could be better - it takes time to get used to using one's fingernails; thankfully the buttons aren't too hard which would have worsened things. The number keypad is also a lot better and well laid out. Feedback is good and the keys are very usable. The screen is the same beautiful unit found on the N78 - no work required here.

On-call the quality of the N79 is really good - Nokia uses top-class antennas in their phones and it shows - the N79 sounded clearer and crisper than anything to date with very good clarity and reception even in zone 2. Its earpiece volume and the quality of the handsfree unit are nearly identical to the N78 and you can use this phone as an MP3 player - music quality is crisp and neutral sounding

with a slight emphasis towards bass that we didn't like; but some surely will. The integrated camera takes good shots although video quality isn't as good. Incidentally the N79 is speedy with Bluetooth transfers and was the second fastest phone throughout this comparison.

At Rs. 20,249 the N79 is expensive. However, as with all phones its street price will be a good bit lower. It's also got a complete feature set and has great performance to boot.

Nokia N85

A compact phone; it has a glossy finish with a line pattern drawn on the rear. It feels very solid in hand and is built well even though this phone doesn't share the steel body inserts that the likes of the E75 and E71 do. The camera has a dual-LED flash and a lens cover; the latter being a rarity these days. The AMOLED (Active Matrix Organic LED) screen is not as clear as the excellent TFT LCD screens on the N95 8 GB and N96; it also looks darker in comparison and this

has nothing to do with the brightness settings. We were surprised since this should not be the case in theory but the display is not as good as some of the other Nokia phones. That being said there's nothing wrong with its crispness and the colours are beautiful. The menu buttons are built into the front panel and the backlight is the only way to notice them. The call buttons are two slashes built into the front and while they're suitably raised from the bezel it's still not as intuitive or

comfortable to use as larger buttons would be. All the buttons are hard to press and this is slightly annoying, particularly the left/right

menu buttons and the main menu and delete buttons. Backlighting on the keys is really good however. The slider mechanism is positive and snappy - better than the slide on the Nokia N95. It's a two-way slider and the other side has backlit multimedia keys. The number keypad is well laid out and reasonably well spaced although the keys are flat and this takes getting used to. However key feedback is good and the keys themselves are well designed so fast SMSing is possible. The hold key on the side is very useful to prevent accidental activation of anything while the device is in your pocket. A 3.5-mm jack is useful and well located on the top of the phone. Nokia has moved to a micro USB data port; we liked the mini USB port it left behind. It has a 1200 mAh battery, decent enough, and the phone is really slim in spite of the large battery. The N85 has an FM transmitter that works up to a range of three metres and allows you to broadcast music on your phone to nearby FM radios. This includes Hi-Fi decks, other cellphones with FM radio and even car decks. The menu intuitiveness is a little better than the E71 and E75, clearly Nokia's 6 series have menus better suited to multimedia use.

The phone itself has very good call clarity although its not the best around. Audio quality during music playback is really good and this phone doubles as a capable MP3 player; you can use your own headphones thanks to a standard 3.5-mm jack. The camera gives really good results after a little tinkering around. The Bluetooth transfer speed is the best in the business. We'd like a larger screen before we justify the price - at Rs. 25,939, it's a really good, feature-rich phone, but the N95 8 GB has a larger screen and would be a better choice.



Nokia N79



Nokia N85